

Public Liability Insurance Options for Badminton Events — A Guide for Your Sister

Part 1: Comparing Insurance Options

Your sister organises badminton events **4 times a week** with **12–24 participants**, operating as a **sole trader** in **London**. Here are the most relevant insurance options, grouped by type.

Option A: Protectivity — Sports Event Insurance (Multi-Event Annual Policy)

Website: protectivity.com/product/sports-event-insurance

- **Type:** Annual multi-event policy — covers up to **52 events per year** (each up to 3 days). This is a strong fit for 4 sessions/week (~200 events/year), but she would need to confirm whether the 52-event cap is sufficient or whether they offer higher limits.
 - **Public Liability:** £2 million, £5 million, or £10 million — choose the level.
 - **Extras available:** Equipment cover, employers' liability (legally required if she uses any helpers, paid or volunteer).
 - **Starting price:** From around £45.56 for a single-day sports event; annual multi-event pricing will vary.
 - **Key point:** Protectivity is a Starpeak brand (the same company whose T&Cs you uploaded), so this T&C document would directly apply to her policy.
 - **Note:** She should check whether "up to 52 events" is enough. With 4 sessions per week, she'd exceed this. She may need to discuss a bespoke arrangement or consider the Sports Business policy instead.
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Option B: Protectivity — Sports Business Insurance

Website: protectivity.com/product/sports-business-insurance

- **Type:** Annual business policy designed for sports and leisure providers — likely the **best fit** because it treats her activity as an ongoing business rather than discrete "events."
 - **Public Liability:** £2 million to £10 million.
 - **Professional Indemnity:** Included — covers claims from advice or instruction.
 - **Extras:** Employers' liability, personal accident, equipment cover.
 - **Starting price:** From around £110.32/year.
 - **Key point:** No per-event cap. This is designed for ongoing sports businesses, which matches her model of regular weekly sessions.
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Option C: Protectivity — Badminton Club Insurance

Website: protectivity.com/product/badminton-club-insurance

- **Type:** Annual policy for badminton clubs and organisations.
 - **Public Liability:** £1 million to £10 million.
 - **Professional Indemnity:** Included as standard.
 - **Extras:** Employers' liability, directors & officers liability, personal accident, equipment cover.
 - **Starting price:** From £3.62/month.
 - **Key point:** This is designed for "clubs" — she would need to confirm with Protectivity whether a sole trader organising pay-to-play sessions qualifies, or whether the Sports Business policy is more appropriate.
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Option D: Insure4Sport — Badminton Coach / Team Insurance

Website: insure4sport.co.uk/sport/badminton

- **Type:** Specialist badminton insurance with options for individual players, teams, and coaches.
 - **Public Liability:** Up to £10 million.
 - **Professional Indemnity:** Available on coaching policies.
 - **Extras:** Personal accident, loss of earnings, employers' liability, equipment cover.
 - **Key point:** Good if she's also coaching. Underwritten by Aviva. Offers a lowest-price guarantee. She should get a quote to compare.
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Option E: Quote Monkey — Badminton Match/Tournament Insurance

Website: quotemonkey.co.uk/badminton-match-insurance

- **Type:** Per-event insurance, ideal for one-off tournaments.
 - **Public Liability:** £2 million for events up to 250 attendees.
 - **Starting price:** From £76 per event.
 - **Key point:** Too expensive for her model (4x/week would cost ~£15,000/year). Only makes sense for occasional tournaments, not regular sessions.
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Option F: Badminton England Membership

Website: badmintonengland.co.uk/membership

- **Type:** Membership-based insurance, not a standalone policy.
- **Public Liability:** Up to £10 million for insured activities.
- **Includes:** Professional indemnity, products liability, personal accident, abuse cover.
- **Key point:** Worth investigating as a **supplement**. If she becomes a Badminton England member and registers on their coaching register, she may get some baseline coverage. However, this is typically designed for affiliated clubs and coaches — she would need to confirm it covers her as an independent event organiser running a commercial operation.

Option G: General Sole Trader Insurance (Hiscox, AXA, Howden)

- **Hiscox:** Public liability from around £5.20/month. General business policy, not sports-specific.
- **AXA:** Sole trader insurance with flexible cover options.
- **Howden:** Self-employed packages combining public liability with other covers.
- **Key point:** These are generalist providers. They may not understand the specific risks of running badminton events (participant injuries, venue requirements, equipment). A specialist sports insurer is likely better value and a better fit.

Summary Comparison

Option	Type	PL Cover	Annual Cost (approx.)	Best For
Protectivity Sports Business	Annual business	£2m– £10m	From ~£110/year	✅ Best fit — ongoing sports business
Protectivity Club Insurance	Annual club	£1m– £10m	From ~£43/year	If she structures as a "club"
Protectivity Multi-Event	Annual events	£2m– £10m	Varies	If under 52 events/year
Insure4Sport	Annual coach/team	Up to £10m	Get quote	If she also coaches
Badminton England	Membership	Up to £10m	Membership fee	Supplementary cover
Quote Monkey	Per-event	£2m	~£76/event	One-off tournaments only
Hiscox / AXA / Howden	General business	£1m– £10m	From ~£60/year	Non-specialist alternative

Recommendation

Protectivity Sports Business Insurance appears to be the strongest option because it's designed for ongoing sports activity businesses, has no per-event cap, includes professional indemnity as standard, and starts at a reasonable price. Since Protectivity is a Starpeak brand, the T&Cs you already have would apply.

She should also consider **Insure4Sport** for a comparison quote, and look into **Badminton England membership** for additional baseline coverage.

Important: Most sports venues and leisure centres require proof of public liability insurance (typically at least £2 million) before they'll let her book. She should check her venue's requirements before choosing a cover level.

Part 2: Disclosure Checklist — What to Tell the Insurer

Under the Insurance Act 2015 (and as stated in Section 4 of the Starpeak T&Cs), your sister has a legal **duty of fair presentation**. She must disclose everything that could affect the insurer's decision. Here's a practical checklist.

A. About Her and the Business

- ☐ **Full legal name** as it will appear on the sole trader registration
 - ☐ **Trading name** (if different from her legal name)
 - ☐ **Business address** (her home address or registered address)
 - ☐ **Date the business started** (or expected start date)
 - ☐ **Sole trader status** — confirm she has no business partners
 - ☐ **HMRC registration status** (or pending)
 - ☐ **UK residency** — confirm she is a UK resident (required by Starpeak)
 - ☐ **Any other business activities** — she is also an actor, producer, and writer. The insurer needs to know this is a separate/additional activity
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B. About the Badminton Events

- ☐ **Exact description of the activity:** organising badminton game sessions (social play, competitive, coached sessions, or a mix?)
- ☐ **Frequency:** 4 sessions per week
- ☐ **Number of participants:** 12–24 per session
- ☐ **Age range of participants** (adults only? any under-18s?)
- ☐ **Skill level:** beginners, intermediate, advanced, or mixed
- ☐ **Whether she provides coaching/instruction** or just organises the games
- ☐ **Session duration** (e.g. 2 hours per session)

- ☐ **Whether sessions are open to the public** or members/registered participants only
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C. About the Venue(s)

- ☐ **Venue name(s) and address(es)**
- ☐ **Type of venue:** leisure centre, school hall, community centre, private sports hall, etc.
- ☐ **Whether she hires/rents the venue** (most likely) or owns it
- ☐ **Venue's own insurance requirements** (minimum PL level they demand)
- ☐ **Whether she uses multiple venues** or always the same one
- ☐ **Any outdoor sessions** (different risk profile to indoor)
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D. About Employees, Helpers, and Volunteers

- ☐ **Does she employ anyone?** Even casual helpers or volunteers count
- ☐ **If yes:** she legally needs Employers' Liability insurance
- ☐ **Does she use any subcontractors?** (e.g. a referee, a coach, a first-aider)
- ☐ **Are subcontractors required to have their own insurance?**
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E. About Equipment

- ☐ **Does she provide equipment?** (nets, rackets, shuttlecocks, etc.)
- ☐ **Estimated value of equipment** she owns
- ☐ **Does she hire or borrow any equipment?**
- ☐ **Where is equipment stored?** (at home, at the venue, in a vehicle)
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F. About Revenue and Charges

- ☐ **Estimated annual turnover** from the badminton events
- ☐ **How participants pay:** per-session fees, memberships, block bookings, etc.
- ☐ **Whether she sells any products** (e.g. shuttlecocks, water, snacks) — this could require Products Liability cover
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G. Claims and Insurance History

- ☐ **Any previous insurance claims** — even on personal policies, if asked
- ☐ **Any previous refusals or cancellations** of insurance by another provider
- ☐ **Any ongoing legal disputes or pending claims**

- ☐ **Any incidents at previous events** (injuries, property damage, complaints) — even if no formal claim was made
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H. Health, Safety, and Qualifications

- ☐ **Any relevant coaching qualifications** (Badminton England coaching certificate, first aid, etc.)
- ☐ **Risk assessment procedures** — does she conduct one for each venue/session?
- ☐ **First aid provision** — does she have a first aid kit? Is anyone first-aid trained?
- ☐ **Participant waivers/disclaimers** — does she ask participants to sign anything?
- ☐ **DBS check** — relevant if any under-18s participate
- ☐ **Badminton England membership** — if she has one, mention it
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I. Changes to Report During the Policy

Once insured, she **must tell the insurer immediately** if any of the following change:

- Number of sessions per week increases
 - Participant numbers grow beyond what was stated
 - She starts using a new or different venue
 - She hires employees or volunteers
 - She adds new activities (e.g. coaching, tournaments, social events)
 - She starts offering sessions to children/minors
 - Any incident occurs that could lead to a claim — even if she thinks it's minor
 - Her business structure changes (e.g. from sole trader to limited company)
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Quick Tips for the Application

1. **Be specific about the activity:** "Organising recreational badminton sessions" is better than "sports events"
 2. **Don't understate participant numbers:** Say "up to 24" rather than "around 12"
 3. **Mention all venues:** Even if one is the main venue
 4. **Disclose everything, even if it seems irrelevant:** Let the insurer decide what matters
 5. **Keep a copy of what she disclosed:** If there's ever a claim, she can prove she was honest
 6. **Ask questions if unsure:** Better to over-disclose than under-disclose
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This guide is for informational purposes only and does not constitute professional insurance or legal advice. Your sister should speak directly with the insurance providers and consider consulting an insurance broker for personalised recommendations.